Part 1

Introducing CORS

Cross-Origin Resource Sharing (CORS) enables web clients to make HTTP requests to servers hosted on different origins. CORS is a unique web technology in that it has both a server-side and a client-side component. The server-side component configures which types of cross-origin requests are allowed, while the client-side component controls how cross-origin requests are made.

Part 1 focuses on the client-side component of CORS. Chapter 1 is an introduction to CORS, how it works, and its benefits. It also gives a taste of what CORS looks like by introducing a sample application that makes CORS requests to the Flickr API.

Chapter 2 dives deeper into this sample application to show how the client-side component of CORS works. It starts by looking at how the browser's `XMLHttpRequest` object (which is already familiar to any developer making same-origin requests) can be used to make cross-origin requests. Then, it turns to Internet Explorer 8 and Internet Explorer 9, which support a subset of CORS via the `XDomainRequest` object. Next, it looks at other places where CORS requests turn up, such as the `canvas` element. The chapter concludes by looking at how CORS requests can be made from jQuery.